

back, plus we tend to remember more of the negatives. It leads to baggage. All the positives we learnt are a part of the present and that is most important. I like the dynamism of the present with respect to the composition of the team and the chemistry that comes with it. Culturally, they are very aligned with the values and much of that is not always easy to articulate. Being frugal, for instance, is not always to cut back on expenses but we do learn what it means over time.

CEO of Blinkit] and I had the right amount of trust. Blinkit will be larger than Zomato in one-tenth the time. The scale it brings to the table is huge. We don't really think [about the] portfolio. Blinkit was about wanting something quickly.

Zomato does not exist in that business. From a customer point of view, we thought, "Who would want anything in 10 minutes?" Then, we piloted the concept in a store next to our office and when things started getting delivered in 10

been made simple, but it's really the outcome of hard work. The current outcomes are a reflection of what was done 12 months ago. Plus, a lot of things can go right or wrong.

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How do you deal with success or failure?

Things go up and down. I don't look at it this way—rather it is discrete and granular for me. It is a sequence of events.

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The buyout of Hyper-

businesses?

The difference between new and old age in my view is that the latter has capex, but we don't. They depreciate the capex and report Ebitda. Our capex is all about technology, building brands, restaurants onboarded. We must be looked at as being asset-heavy or asset-light and that needs to be understood. We keep it simple—account for all costs and revenue and if I can't predict the future, how do I move businesses to the future? People are starting to get it now.

“The big thing is we are one of the biggest users of both our services. I use [Zomato and Blinkit] at least twice a day, if not more”

The big thing is we are one of the biggest users of our services. I use both our products at least twice a day if not more. If we do that, we are always seeing gaps and therefore, it becomes a never-ending journey.

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Speaking of filling gaps in the portfolio, how has Blinkit changed the business?

At that time [when it was acquired], it was a culmination [of] everything that we learnt about customer first... Albi [Albinder Dhindsa, Founder &

minutes, it was a very different feeling. There was something magical about 10 minutes. It's not a crazy timeline and it's cheaper to do a 10-minute model since distances are lesser. People said, "it costs more", but we said, no!

This is not a pan-India model and there is no need for it to be one. This is a hyperlocal model, and the density of population determines the opening of a store. Zomato has data on population and driving distance. That data is used for Blinkit store-mapping. It has

pure in FY19 was an interesting deal. How did you view it then?

It is only 10% done and has a long way to go. We look at it as a 25-year bet in terms of playing out. It was set up to clean the supply chain in food. Ordering better food is always the objective. From a financial point of view, it is not a long-gestation game but achieving that vision of supply chain of food or just better food is a long haul.

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Do investors take time to understand new-age

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There were some prominent exits right after Zomato got listed...

I was hopeful that the IPO will not change the commitment levels. Obviously, a lot changed in their lives, and they saw a lot of money suddenly. Half the folks who quit did not agree with themselves that they were done. Their behaviour at work was not about being proactive but only reactive. Retirement mode had set in and in hindsight, I thought it would happen. I let it fester and spoke to them to get their mindset back in shape. Finally, I had to take over. It was not an easy decision but [it] had to be done. This is a dynamic environment, and you have to change. **BT**

@krishnagopalan